

Born in the city-state of Arezzo, some 50 miles (80 km) south of Florence, in about 990 CE, Guido Monaco became known as Guido d'Arezzo as his fame spread throughout the world of Italian church music. Little is known about his family or early life, except that he was educated at the Benedictine abbey of Pomposa on the northeast coast of Italy, and served there as a monk when he was young.



**AERIAL VIEW OF POMPOSA
ABBEY**

The imposing bell tower of Pomposa Abbey, where Guido spent several years of his life, dominates the spectacular Codigoro landscape in northeast Italy.

Solving problems

At Pomposa, Guido showed great musical talent and, noticing the difficulties the monks had in learning the plainsong melodies, gained a reputation as an inspirational teacher. He also studied music theory and developed ways to improve the singers' ability to learn the chants by heart, using a sketchy system of notation as